

WEEK 4 OF 4 · Mind

Script 4: The Shadow Battle (Active Creative Form)**Theme: Integrating Mind, Body, and Breath**

Rationale: An active drill that challenges the student to maintain mindfulness while moving freely, simulating the chaos of combat without a physical partner.

Divide students into groups or have them find their own space on the floor. This is done standing and moving — not in a seated meditative stance.

"We are going to enter the 'Mind Lab.' You are going to create your own form right now, in the moment. I want you to imagine you are surrounded by imaginary opponents. They are attacking from the front, the sides, the back.

Begin to move. Block. Strike. Evade. But here is the challenge: Keep your awareness on your breath, your posture, and your balance. If you feel yourself holding your breath, stop and reset. If you feel yourself rushing, slow down.

(Allow students to move for 60 seconds.)

Notice: Are you tense? Are you fluid? Don't plan the next move. Let your body respond to the imaginary attack. Keep your mind right here, in this battle, nowhere else.

(Pause.) And... stop. Return to center."

Pro-Tip: If students look confused or self-conscious, have them start with a specific combination (e.g., Jab-Cross-Spawl) before letting them freestyle.

MINDFULNESS ON THE MATS